

SUPPLEMENTARY SHEET 2

THE TIMELINE FOR SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

THE UN CONFERENCE ON HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

What: UN Conference on Human Development

Where: Stockholm

When: 1972

Detail: The first time the international community met to consider the global environment and development needs
The Stockholm Declaration and Action Plan was developed, which defined the principles for the preservation and enhancement of the natural environment and highlighted the need to support people in this process.

Website: <http://www.unep.org/>

OUR COMMON FUTURE

What: The Bruntland Commission or the UN World Commission on the Environment and Development

When: 1983

Detail: The Commission was set up to focus on the causes of environmental problems rather than the effects of environmental degradation.
Framed much of what would become the 40 chapters of Agenda 21 and the 27 principles of the Rio Declaration on Environment and Development.

Website: World Commission on Sustainable Development. 1987. Our Common Future. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Canada's Response to Our Common Future

What: The creation of the National Round Table on the Environment and the Economy

Where: Canada

When: 1989

Detail: Comprised of representatives from government, industry, science, education, NGOs and native peoples to advise the Prime Minister of Canada on policies for Sustainable Development and to develop strategies for action. Learning for a Sustainable Future, a sustainable development education program is a spinoff of the round table
(<http://www.schoolnet.ca/learning/>).

Website: <http://www.nrtee-trnee.ca>

The Earth Summit

What: The UN Conference on Environment and Development or the Earth Summit

Where: Rio de Janeiro

When: 1992

Detail: Accepted Agenda 21 and the Rio Declaration, which outlined key policies for achieving sustainable development that meets the needs of the poor and recognizes the limits of development to meet global needs.

Result: Brought the environment and development into the public arena and led to the development of two legally binding documents; a) Biological diversity and b) The Framework Convention on Sustainable Development. Led to the formation of the Commission for Sustainable Development (CSD).

Website: <http://www.un.org/geninfo/bp/enviro.html>

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AGENDA 21

What: A comprehensive plan of action to be taken globally, nationally and locally by organizations of the United Nations System, governments, and major groups in every area in which human impacts on the environment.

Where: Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

When: 1992

Detail: Outlines strategies and integrated program measures to halt and reverse the effects of environmental degradation. It promotes environmental renewal and sustainable development in all countries.

Agenda 21, the Rio Declaration on Environment and Development, and the Statement of principles for the Sustainable Management of Forests were adopted by more than 178 governments at the United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED). Agenda 21 called for a total shift in the status quo of value systems and institutional processes.

Website: <http://www.un.org/esa/sustdev/agenda21.htm>

The International Institute for Sustainable Development

What: IISD is an organization that promotes the transition toward a sustainable future. It seeks to demonstrate how human ingenuity can be applied to improve the well-being of the environment, economy and society.

When: 1988

Where: Winnipeg, Manitoba

Detail: In 1988, Prime Minister Brian Mulroney announced, to the General Assembly of the United Nations the creation of the International Institute for Sustainable Development in Winnipeg. IISD officially opened in March 1990.

Website: www.iisd.org

Rio + 5

What: The Earth Summit Review

Where: New York

When: 1997

Detail: The goal of Rio + 5 was to assess the progress made since the 1992 Earth Summit. Several gaps were identified with regard to social equity and poverty due to falling official development assistance to poor countries and growing international debt.

Result: Called for stronger implementation of the growing number of international agreements and conventions which pertain to the environment and development.

Website: http://www.un.org/esa/sustdev/CSD_5th.htm

The Earth Summit 2002

What: Rio' Earth Summit +10

Where: Johannesburg, South Africa

When: August 26, 2002

Detail: The goal of the summit was to identify concrete steps for moving forward on a number of priority areas of sustainable development

Anticipated Results: The Summit reaffirmed sustainable development as a central element of the international agenda and gave new impetus to global action to fight poverty and protect the environment. Governments agreed to and reaffirmed a wide range of concrete commitments and targets for action to achieve more effective implementation of sustainable development objectives.

Website: <http://www.johannesburgsummit.org/index.html>